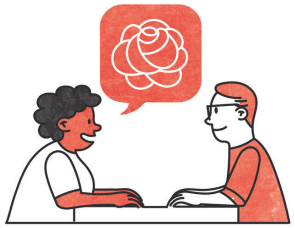
DSA commits to the goal of becoming an independent mass socialist party, with the following principles:

1. The fundamental purpose of a socialist party is to be **a mass association of the working class formed for collective political action**. The party will be united around a democratically created program that outlines goals that, enacted together, will allow the working class to rule and end capitalism.



2. The foundation of party democracy is **freedom of information, association, and discussion**. Members must be able to critique the party's program and organize to change it, as long as they are willing to accept fighting for it as the democratically-determined expression of DSA's goals.



*3.*The internal governing principles of the party must guarantee **all members equal right of participation** in the democratic process, **regular conventions** of membership as the highest decision-making body, **open leadership elections** at conventions, **local party organizations** run by membership, and the **free organization of factions**.

4. Guaranteeing members equal right of participation in the democratic process requires that **participation be reserved for individual members**. Groups may choose to affiliate with DSA on the basis of acceptance of our program, but may not be given voting rights as an organization.

5. Because of an uneven and undemocratic electoral system designed to maintain capitalist rule, DSA fights on unfavorable terrain and is pulled between the necessity of independent political action and using the ballot line of the Democratic Party. DSA's approach is **the party surrogate, acting as a party but without a dedicated ballot line**.



6. While DSA must move away from use of the Democratic Party ballot line and primaries, a ballot line is not the primary goal or indication of political independence. What matters most is **bringing our independent organization and program to races** whether on a Democratic, independent, or third- party ballot line.

7. When considering whether to create a ballot line of our own, losing control of our candidates to an open state-run process is a non-negotiable red line. **Our ability to take independent political action is essential** to preserve above all other considerations.



8. DSA orients itself in opposition to all ruling class political forces. DSA's project is **to unite workers to win the battle for democracy and bring about socialism**, not to seek a governing coalition with a perceived lesser evil under the current undemocratic political system.

9. A socialist party in the United States must be a part of **the global political movement of the working class**. It is guided by the international interests of the class, not narrow national interests.



10. The socialist movement is strengthened by putting forward **common perspectives and engaging in common action** internationally. DSA will continue to build ties with socialist parties around the world with the goal of **forming a new International**.



PRINCIPLES *for* PARTY BUILDING



AS ADOPTED BY THE

DSA
NATIONAL
CONVENTION
2025

A better world is possible.

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